

**ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026**

# Construction and Architecture English

## Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

**PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK**

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For architects, construction managers, project engineers, site supervisors, estimators, owners' representatives, subcontractor coordinators, and design-build teams.

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

# Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

## 01 Design Intent and Client Requirements

Clarify missing information before responding.

## 02 Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

## 03 Change Orders and Cost Control

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

## 04 Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

## 05 Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Clarify missing information before responding.

## 06 Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

## 07 Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

## 08 Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

## Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one case and saying a response. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, conversation, writing, and revision.

## Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

## LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

# Design Intent and Client Requirements

Clarify missing information before responding.

**SITUATION**

A client describes a meeting space as "flexible" but has not specified occupancy, furniture changes, or audiovisual needs.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

design intent - Functional, aesthetic, performance, and user objectives the design must preserve as details are developed.

program - In architecture, a statement of required spaces, functions, and user needs; elsewhere, an organized set of activities.

constructability - Extent to which a design can be built safely, efficiently, and reliably using available methods, materials, and sequencing.

scope - Defined boundary of work, responsibility, deliverables, assumptions, and exclusions.

## 3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is ... . Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

## LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Ask a precise question

## 4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
  - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
  - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
  - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
  - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
  - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
  - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

## LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

# Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

**SITUATION**

A drawing and specification appear to describe different finishes for the same area. The site team needs a documented clarification.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

RFI - Request for information used to resolve an ambiguity, conflict, or missing detail in contract documents or a project scope.

specification - A detailed statement of required characteristics, performance, or materials.

drawing set - The collection of drawings that describes a design or construction project.

submittal - Information supplied by a contractor for required review, such as product data or shop drawings.

## 3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ... .

Improve this sentence: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

## LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Ask for an actionable next step

## 4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
  - A. Send it only after Thursday.
  - B. Send it on a date later than Thursday.
  - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
  - A. Could you do the needful for the situation?
  - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
  - C. Could you deal with the relevant matters soon?

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

## LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

# Change Orders and Cost Control

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

**SITUATION**

A client requests an additional partition after pricing is agreed. Cost and schedule effects have not been assessed.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

change order - A documented modification to agreed construction work, often affecting price or time.

allowance - An amount included in a construction budget for an item not yet fully specified.

contingency - A possible future condition or provision for it; in contracts, a condition affecting the transaction.

notice - A formal communication informing a party about an event, requirement, or proposed action.

## 3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that ... .

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm ... .

Improve this sentence: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

## LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Offer a workable tradeoff

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
  - A. If the scope changed tomorrow, we reviewed the schedule yesterday.
  - B. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
  - C. If the scope will change, we review yesterday's schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
  - A. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.
  - B. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
  - C. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.



## LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

# Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

**SITUATION**

A delivery delay affects a task on the current critical path. A lookahead schedule still shows the original sequence.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

critical path - Sequence of dependent work that determines the shortest feasible timeline.

float - The amount a scheduled activity can move without delaying a specified project milestone under the schedule model.

lookahead schedule - A detailed plan for work expected in the near term.

resequencing - Changing the planned order of activities.

## 3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is ... .

The next update will cover ... .

Improve this sentence: Everything is progressing well.

## LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Give a useful status update

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
  - A. The team has completed the review.
  - B. The team is completing the review.
  - C. The team plans to complete the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
  - A. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
  - B. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
  - C. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

## LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

# Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Clarify missing information before responding.

**SITUATION**

In a toolbox-talk exercise, an instruction says to use "the right protection" without identifying the task or approved requirement.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

PPE - Personal protective equipment selected and used under applicable task-specific safety requirements.

fall protection - Systems and measures used under approved procedures to address the risk of falls from height.

toolbox talk - A short, task-relevant safety discussion conducted under an organization's safety arrangements.

stop work - A call or authorized action to pause work when a safety concern requires attention under local procedures.

## 3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is ... . Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

## LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Ask a precise question

## 4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
  - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
  - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
  - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
  - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
  - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
  - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

## LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

# Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

**SITUATION**

An inspection note identifies outstanding items, but a progress email says the area is fully approved.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

permit - Official permission for an activity under specified requirements.

inspection - An examination of an item or condition against relevant requirements.

code compliance - Conformity with the applicable building, engineering, or other technical code requirements.

reinspection - An additional inspection, often to check correction of previously identified issues.

## 3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ... .

Improve this sentence: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

## LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Ask for an actionable next step

## 4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
  - A. Send it on a date later than Thursday.
  - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
  - C. Send it only after Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
  - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
  - B. Could you deal with the relevant matters soon?
  - C. Could you do the needful for the situation?

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

## LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

# Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

**SITUATION**

A closeout list contains eight items, with three completed and five awaiting review. The incoming coordinator needs the supporting records.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

punch list - A list of outstanding construction items requiring completion or correction.

substantial completion - A contract-defined construction stage when work is sufficiently complete for its intended use, subject to applicable terms.

warranty - A promise or contractual assurance about a product or work, with defined terms and remedies.

closeout - The documented completion and transfer of a project's remaining obligations and records.

## 3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is ... .

The record shows ... .

Please confirm who has accepted ... .

Improve this sentence: Someone should follow up on this.

## LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Transfer information and responsibility

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
  - A. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
  - B. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
  - C. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
  - A. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
  - B. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.
  - C. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.



## LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

# Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

**SITUATION**

A project team wants to say a delay automatically entitles it to compensation. The contract and records have not been reviewed.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

claim - A statement that may need evidence, approval, qualification, or disclosure before it is used externally.

daily report - A dated record of work, conditions, events, or progress during a day.

meeting minutes - A written record of key discussion points, decisions, and agreed actions.

entitlement - A right to a benefit or remedy under applicable rules or an agreement.

## 3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows ... .

This may indicate ..., but ... .

We have not yet established whether ... .

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

## LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

# Match certainty to evidence

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
  - A. The change must have caused the delay.
  - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
  - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
  - A. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...
  - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
  - C. In every location, the result will be ...

## 5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

## 6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

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Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

# Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response, not a script to memorize. Your written version needs a subject line, an opening, and appropriate context. Assess it using the four criteria at the end.

## 01 | Design Intent and Client Requirements

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

### Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

### Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: What activities should the space support, and how often will the layout change? Let's clarify occupancy and equipment needs so the design brief gives the team a usable direction.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 02 | Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

### Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This reverses the meaning of the deadline.

B: A later date does not meet a 'by Thursday' deadline.

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

### Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This expression does not identify the specific action needed.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: 'Relevant matters' and 'soon' leave the task unclear.

Model response: Could the design team confirm the intended finish and relevant revision? I'll identify the conflicting references in a request for information rather than assume which instruction takes precedence.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 03 | Change Orders and Cost Control

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the if-clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

### Check 1: B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The conflicting time references make the condition unclear.

B: The if-clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

C: The tense pattern and time reference do not express the intended future condition.

### Check 2: A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

B: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

C: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

Model response: We can review the partition as a proposed change. Let's assess its cost and schedule effect through the agreed change process before confirming that it is included in the current price.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 04 | Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

### Check 1: A - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

B: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

C: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

### Check 2: C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

B: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

C: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

Model response: The delayed delivery affects a critical-path task. I'll update the lookahead and show the feasible resequencing options for review instead of leaving the original dates unexplained.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 05 | Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

### Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

### Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Which task and approved safety requirement does this refer to? Please have the authorized person clarify the instruction before work proceeds. The language needs to be specific enough to understand and check.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 06 | Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

### Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: A later date does not meet a 'by Thursday' deadline.

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: This reverses the meaning of the deadline.

### Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: 'Relevant matters' and 'soon' leave the task unclear.

C: This expression does not identify the specific action needed.

Model response: Could you confirm the inspection status and the items still outstanding? I'll correct the progress wording so it does not imply approval that has not been documented.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 07 | Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

### Check 1: A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

B: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

C: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

### Check 2: C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: It changes pending information into a final result.

B: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

C: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

Model response: Three items are complete, and five await review. The list links each item to its record and responsible party. Please confirm the remaining review steps before reporting closeout as finished.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 08 | Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

### Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

### Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

Model response: The delay and its effects should be documented, but entitlement requires appropriate contract and legal review. I'll separate the factual record from any conclusion about a claim.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

# Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

## Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

## Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

## Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

## Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

## Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

## Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

## Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.



# Use the language responsibly

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

## Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

## Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

### Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

### Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

## Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.